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DJIA Closed (53414.25)

NASDAQ Closed (26506.99)

STOXX 600 649.90 ▲ 0.003%

10-YR. TREAS. Closed (4.783%)

OIL Closed (\$91.48)

GOLD Closed (\$4,429.80)

EURO \$1.1623

YEN 154.34

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Stock investors braced** for a bumpy autumn as they anticipate a Fed decision on interest rates and face a persistent inflation threat as fighting in the Middle East drags on. **A1**

◆ **Americans without** college degrees are experiencing one of the best job markets in years, while young graduates are finding it harder to nail an offer. **A1**

◆ **Fewer U.S. workers** are leaving their employers even as the labor market adds about 80,000 new jobs a month, settling into a “low hire, low fire” pattern. **A2**

◆ **Jaguar Land Rover** will cut 4,000 jobs as the automaker contends with Trump’s tariffs, a sales collapse in China and big investments in electric vehicles. **B1**

◆ **Robinhood’s role** as underwriter to Oura’s recent initial public offering raises the retail brokerage’s profile—and clout—among its own investors. **B1**

◆ **Florida-based EverBank** Financial reached a deal to pursue a reverse merger with WaFd, a smaller bank in the Pacific Northwest. **B3**

◆ **Antonio Gracias** and Steve Jurvetson, directors at SpaceX, spent millions of dollars on efforts to mainstream psychedelic drugs, including MDMA, the drug commonly known as ecstasy. **B4**

◆ **Money managers** are turning to AI agents to help them manage their portfolios in a development that executives predict will reshape the world of retail investing. **B5**

Worldwide

◆ **Germany’s embattled** leader faces an uphill battle to save his government after a historic far-right election victory that could reshape the country’s political system. **A1**

◆ **Iran’s oil export revenue** is drying up as a U.S. naval blockade strangles shipments from the Persian Gulf and offshore stockpiles feeding China dwindle. **A1**

◆ **Belgium’s revelation** that it had arrested a Chinese citizen on suspicion of stealing microchip technology raised European anxiety about Beijing’s quest for industrial secrets. **A10**

◆ **Greenland is cashing** in on Trump’s threats and talk of dealmaking by using its position as a strategic Arctic linchpin to draw investments from European allies. **A9**

◆ **Trump on social media** called for changing New Mexico’s name to “New America,” his most ambitious attempt yet to remake the North American map. **A3**

◆ **Trump’s super PAC** entered the Senate race in Texas with its largest outlay of the current political cycle to back Republican Ken Paxton and oppose Democrat James Talarico. **A4**

◆ **Hunter Biden was set** to launch a meme coin named for his own laptop computer, whose contents became the subject of a political outcry starting in 2020. **A4**

◆ **The Kang Kon**, a North Korean warship that partially capsized at its initial launch in 2025, was commissioned into Pyongyang’s navy after a refit. **A10**

◆ **Israel’s air force** carried out two airstrikes on a village in southern Lebanon, killing at least 12 people and wounding others, Lebanon’s Health Ministry said, amid a new round of escalation between Israel and Hezbollah. **A6**

JOURNAL REPORT

Investing Monthly: You can gift more tax-free than you think. **R1-6**

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Speed, Weather to Be Probed in Cargo Plane Crash



LYNNE SUDRYAP

FIERY LANDING: An Amazon cargo plane sat at Miami International Airport on Monday after it overshot the runway the day before and crashed into vehicles, killing at least five. The craft’s speed and stormy weather will be part of the investigation. **A5**

Big Win for German Far Right Puts Chancellor in Tight Spot

After state-election loss, Merz faces pressure to weaken firewall against AfD

By BERTRAND BENOIT

BERLIN—Germany’s embattled leader faces an uphill battle to save his government after a historic far-right victory on Sunday that could reshape the country’s political system.

Chancellor Friedrich Merz sounded both humbled and defiant when he addressed his Christian Democratic Union

party’s defeat on Monday by the Alternative for Germany, or AfD, in the eastern state of Saxony-Anhalt. “This is the worst defeat the CDU has experienced in years, even decades,” he said. “It will of course have consequences.”

But he signaled he would stay the course on some of his signature policies. He pledged to deliver on a package of measures aimed at boosting Germany’s struggling economy, and he said his government would be unwavering in its support for Ukraine. AfD has criticized Germany’s support for Kyiv and favors

stronger ties with Russia. “Giving up is no option,” Merz said.

The election defeat and sagging poll numbers have put Merz in a corner that will leave him with difficult choices, such as potentially ending the unspoken rule among Germany’s establishment parties to ostracize the far right. At stake is whether Europe’s largest economy and the region’s emerging conventional military superpower will succumb to the political instability that is plaguing its neighbors from the U.K. to France.

The AfD scored 43.8% of

votes in Sunday’s election in Saxony-Anhalt, its best result in any state since its creation. Merz’s CDU saw its portion of the vote more than halve to 17.2%, worse than any poll had predicted.

Despite its victory, the AfD finished just short of a majority of seats that would have allowed it to form a state government. Its leaders said on Monday they would approach other parties and individual state lawmakers to persuade them to back an AfD-led government.

So far, no party has said it
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Legal Fight Is Brewing At Oktoberfest

* * *
The fun goes flat in a dispute over who can sell suds

By PATIENCE HAGGIN

MUNICH—Beer isn’t just a drink here. It’s tradition and identity. And, for some, grounds for an antitrust war.

For generations, the same beer makers have poured every drop at Oktoberfest. Organizers say it’s all about maintaining the purity of the Bavarian bacchanal. Critics call it a straight-up cartel. A showdown is brewing over exactly who can sell suds, run tents and otherwise participate in the party.

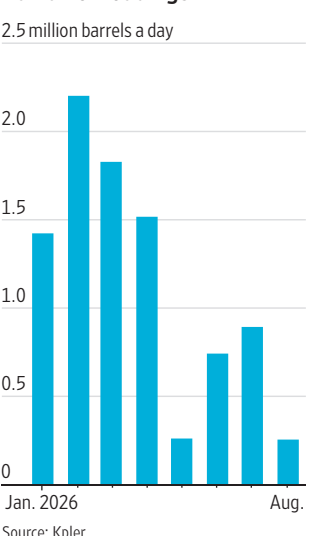
“It’s the hardest battle you can fight in Munich,” said Steffen Marx, who has dreamed of selling his Giesinger Bräu at Oktoberfest since founding the brewery in a garage in 2006. He has gathered 21,000 of 35,000 signatures needed to call a citywide referendum that could get his beer inside the gates next year.

Each fall, Munich is taken over by Oktoberfest. This year, 6.7 million revelers are expected to descend upon the city beginning Sept. 19 to guz-



By invitation only.

Iranian oil loadings



Iran’s Oil Revenue Dwindles, Worsening Economic Crisis

By GEORGI KANTCHEV AND SUMMER SAID

DUBAI—Iran’s oil-export revenue is drying up as a U.S. naval blockade strangles shipments from the Persian Gulf and offshore stockpiles feeding China dwindle, putting more pressure on Tehran’s battered economy.

No Iranian crude has crossed the blockade since it was reinstated by the U.S.

Navy in mid-July, according to ship tracker Kpler. Iran is still loading small amounts of oil onto tankers, but those barrels remain trapped inside the Gulf.

Meanwhile, the volume of Iranian crude already on vessels outside the blockade—a trove that is still generating revenue for Tehran—has fallen to around 29 million barrels from around 90 million barrels in mid-July and could run out in October, according to Kpler.

Gulf oil officials, who run checks to see what their customers are buying before setting the monthly price for their oil, said they have found few Iranian cargoes changing hands.

Six months into the war, the oil squeeze is depriving Tehran of its main source of foreign currency as the value

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◆ **Iran has a financial lifeline:** U.S. banks..... **A6**

Young Israeli Nomads Defy Law and Order

Squatters use violence to push Palestinians from the West Bank in the name of God

By FELIZ SOLOMON AND SHOSHANNA SOLOMON

Loui Ridi keeps watch from his balcony on a pair of dusty camper vans parked a stone’s throw from his yard, bracing for the next attack.

The vans belong to young Israeli squatters who play their own waiting

game, smoking cigarettes and milling about. Their very presence is a scare tactic in a long-running campaign of violence and intimidation by extremists seeking to drive Palestinians out of the West Bank.

“I am looking at them as we speak,” Ridi said by phone from his balcony. In spring, a security camera at his house

recorded masked and hooded figures who scaled his garden wall and used a ladder to disable the camera.

Ridi, a 46-year-old U.S. citizen, left his Ohio home in August to defend his property in the village of Qusra, where he grew up. By the time he arrived, the Israeli military had torn down the

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Job Market Looks Good If You Never Got Degree

By THEO FRANCIS AND RAY A. SMITH

For most U.S. workers—those without college degrees, that is—it is one of the best job markets in decades.

In fact, the unemployment rate for workers ages 22 to 34 who never graduated from college has rarely been lower in the past two decades, according to a new analysis by labor-market think tank

Burning Glass Institute.

What is just as remarkable is how different that is from the experience of job seekers who did graduate from college, said Gad Levanon, Burning Glass’s chief economist. For most of the past two decades, the two groups largely tracked each other, in good

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◆ **Workers hang on tightly to their jobs**..... **A2**

INSIDE



U.S. NEWS
Lower Manhattan is roaring back 25 years after the Sept. 11 attacks. **A3**

JASON GAY
A second chance saved the Michigan Wolverines in their football opener. **A18**